

Bradford School District

School Health and Wellness Policy

Purpose

The Bradford School District is committed to providing a school environment that promotes and protects children's health, well-being, and ability to learn. This policy supports healthy eating, physical activity, and overall wellness in alignment with federal and Arkansas state requirements.

I. Wellness Policy Leadership

The district will establish a **Wellness Committee** that includes:

- District administrators
- School food service staff
- School nurses
- Teachers
- Parents/guardians
- Students (when appropriate)
- Community members

Responsibilities:

- Develop, implement, and review wellness initiatives
 - Ensure compliance with federal and state regulations
 - Evaluate progress annually
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II. Nutrition Promotion

The district will:

- Promote healthy food and beverage choices using evidence-based strategies
 - Encourage participation in school meal programs
 - Use marketing and messaging that supports nutritious foods
 - Provide nutrition education through classroom instruction and school activities
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III. Nutrition Standards

School Meals

All meals served through the National School Lunch and Breakfast Programs will:

- Meet or exceed USDA nutrition standards

- Offer a variety of fruits, vegetables, whole grains, and low-fat dairy
- Limit sodium, saturated fat, and added sugars

Competitive Foods and Beverages

Foods sold outside the school meal programs (vending, fundraisers, concessions) must:

- Meet USDA Smart Snacks standards
- Be age-appropriate and portion-controlled

Celebrations and Rewards

- Encourage non-food rewards
- Promote healthy food options during classroom celebrations

IV. Physical Activity

Physical Education

- All students will receive regular, standards-based physical education
- Classes will be taught by certified instructors when possible
- Programs will emphasize lifelong fitness and skill development

Daily Physical Activity

- Students will have opportunities for physical activity throughout the school day
- Elementary students will receive daily recess
- Schools will encourage movement breaks during classroom instruction

Before and After School Programs

- Schools will offer or promote extracurricular physical activity opportunities

V. Other School-Based Wellness Activities

The district will:

- Provide a safe and clean environment for physical activity
- Support mental health and social-emotional learning programs
- Promote staff wellness initiatives
- Encourage family and community involvement in wellness activities

VI. School Health Services

- Access to school nursing services

- Health screenings as required by Arkansas law
 - Referrals to community health resources when needed
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VII. Implementation and Monitoring

- The Superintendent or designee will oversee policy implementation
 - Schools will track compliance and progress
 - The district will conduct a comprehensive assessment at least once every three years
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VIII. Public Involvement and Transparency

The district will:

- Make this policy available to the public
 - Provide updates on wellness initiatives
 - Invite stakeholders to participate in policy review
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IX. Policy Review

This policy will be reviewed and updated at least every three years or as required by law.

Adoption

Adopted by the Bradford School District Board of Education on: 5-4-20